slender aphrodite has overcome me with longing for a girl

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/31641962.

Rating:
General Audiences

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Perfuma/Scorpia (She-Ra), Bow/Glimmer (She-Ra)

Characters:
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Additional Tags:
Some Cursing, i did way too much research for this fic, Alternate Universe - High School, High School, no magic, Alternate Universe - No Powers, Human Catra (She-Ra), Alternate Universe - Human, i thiiink thats all the tags i need?, anyway, they are GOING to have a prom and it is GOING to be cute goddammit!!!!, the author knows nothing about clothing so please ignore her opinions on that part, sorry this took forever btw, also I'm pretty sure this is going to be the last installment, Modern Era, Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Prom

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Part 5 of high school catradora

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by StopIWantToTalkAboutCheese

Summary

Catra and Adora go to prom together.

Notes

Title is a Sappho quote! I was tempted to go with Prom(ise), because I love puns, but idk, I like quotes better. (Can you tell I'm an English nerd?)

Anyway, I hope you enjoy!

See the end of the work for more notes

"I *can't believe* you asked her and didn't tell me."

Catra groaned, leaning against Scorpia's bedpost, ignoring the abundance of *frills* on the blankets. "Shut up, Scorpia."

Scorpia sprawled out across her bed and poked Catra's head. "Oh, come on! I'm the whole reason you guys are together!"

Catra's mouth fell open. "You are *not!* Besides, you didn't tell *me* when Perfuma asked *you* out!"

Scorpia raised her hands in surrender, but she was still grinning. Catra rolled her eyes and glanced over at Entrapta, who was perched on Scorpia's desk and fiddling with some bits of metal.

"So, what are you going to wear?" Scorpia asked, and Catra looked back at her.

"Wear? I don't know. I guess I didn't really think about it. I don't know if I have anything nice enough."

Scorpia's eyes lit up.

"Wait!" Catra tried, but it was too late. Scorpia leapt off the bed, grabbed Entrapta's arm and Catra's leg when she tried to jump away, and swept both of them up in a hug.

"We're going on a shopping trip!" Scorpia shouted in Catra's ear, and Catra groaned.

"Ugh!"

"She asked you out?"

"Yes!" Adora said, waving her phone at Bow.

And you said *yes?"*

"Obviously!"

"Guess she's not as psycho as we thought," Glimmer mused, and Adora whacked her with a pillow.

"Catra's great! Come on, remember when we saved her from that killer robot Entrapta made?"

"Oh my *god,"* Bow said, sitting up with wide eyes. "That thing was *huge,* it was *way* too big, and I swear, it's eyes were looking straight into my *soul–"*

"And *you* got to save the day with your buddies from that cake shop, whom we paid off to never speak of it to anyone," Glimmer broke in. "We all remember."

"So, you have any plans for prom night?" Bow asked, waving Glimmer off. "You know… to show Catra a good time?"

"Oh, my god," Adora said, sitting up. "Plans? What do you mean, *plans?* I have to *plan?"*

"Good going, *Bow,"* Glimmer hissed, but Adora wasn't listening anymore.

"I– I need a corkboard. And string! We need string. Glimmer, *tell me you have a corkboard and string."*

"This is your fault, Bow," Glimmer said, getting up. "Come on, Adora, I think we have some stuff downstairs."

Shopping. It was long, it was painful, and Catra was just about ready to pull her own hair out by the two hour mark, but now they were going on *three* hours, and Catra was ready to drop.

She had picked out the first thing she'd seen at the very first store– a simple red and black suit. She wasn't really a *dress* person, though she got the appeal. But Scorpia– Scorpia just *could not choose.*

And Entrapta was no help. She was planning on going to prom for the food, but she hadn't asked anyone, and she certainly hadn't shown any indication of wanting to dress up for it.

"How about this one?" Scorpia asked, showing off the fourth or fifth dress of the last half hour. "What do you guys think?"

"Red looks cool, I guess," Catra said, sharing a bemused glance with Entrapta. "What's Perfuma wearing? Do you guys want to match?" That was a thing, right? Matching at prom?

But Scorpia just shrugged. "I think we'll just have to wait and see!" she said, unerringly cheerful. "Besides, I like this one." She paused for a long moment, examining the dress. "Yeaaaah… this one. I want this one."

"You sure?" Catra said. "Because you said the same thing about the blue dress, and the green dress, and the black dress–"

"And the silver one," Entrapta added. "And the striped one, and the other blue one, and the other other blue one–"

"Okay, okay, I get it!" Scorpia said with a short laugh. "Jeez, you guys." She returned to looking at the dress, but something in her expression was off. Instantly, Catra felt a pang of regret.

"Um– but we don't mind," Catra said quickly. "Right, Entrapta? Take your time, Scorpia. The dress thing is important to you. We get it."

Scorpia shot her a grateful look, but gave a resolute nod. "I like this one," she said.

"Great," Catra said. "Let's go pay for it."

Scorpia hurried to the register, and Catra steered Entrapta outside before she could run off.

They stood outside for a few minutes until Scorpia joined them, looking flushed with excitement and clutching her bag so tightly

Catra worried the plastic would break.

Suddenly, Scorpia's eyes landed on a nail salon across the way, and her eyes lit up. Catra and Entrapta exchanged a glance, and for a split second, they were on the exact same wavelength: *time for a distraction.*

"Food!" Catra suggested loudly, nodding at the food court.

"Yes!" Entrapta squealed. "Ohhh, this is the place with the tiny tart shop! I will be *right back."*

Entrapta dove into the crowds, purple hair bobbing up and down, and Catra turned to Scorpia.

"Well, she's gone for the next hour and a half," she said.

"Aw, I don't blame her," Scorpia said. "They have so many cool fillings! It's so hard to choose!"

Catra sighed and sat in a nearby chair, sprawling out over it. Scorpia sat across from her much more primly, setting their bags on the ground.

For a long moment, they just sat there in silence. Catra wondered if she could take out her phone to text Adora, or if that would be rude. As it turned out, she wouldn't have to.

"Have you ever kissed anyone before?" Scorpia asked suddenly.

Catra choked on thin air. *"What?"*

"Well, have you?"

"Of course!" Catra said defensively, but it was only partly true. She'd *been* kissed, certainly, but she had never really been the one to initiate it. In fact, the last person she'd kissed… had it been Double Trouble, right before everything went to shit with them? It must have been. And that had hardly been what Catra would call a successful relationship.

"I only ask because… well… I kissed Perfuma a few days ago," Scorpia said, fiddling with her hands. She ducked her head even as Catra looked at her in surprise.

…Did Scorpia look *guilty?*

Catra frowned at her friend. "Hey, I didn't know that."

Scorpia shrugged, looking awkward. "Yeah… I don't know. It was cool."

Catra was silent for a moment, wondering what she was going to say, or if she would say anything at all.

"...What did it feel like?" she finally asked, and Scorpia's eyes lit up. Clearly, she had been waiting for Catra to ask.

"Incredible," she said. "Amazing. Show-stopping. It's like…" she paused, and thought for a moment. "Like fireworks."

"Fireworks," Catra said neutrally.

"Oh, yeah. It was fun."

"Huh." Catra leaned back in her seat. "Fireworks."

She touched her lips with her fingertips and wondered.

"Adora, seriously, you've got to stop pacing," Glimmer said.

"How can I?" Adora asked. "I'm *so stressed out!"*

Out of the corner of her eye, she saw Bow and Glimmer exchange a glance. She gritted her teeth.

"It's just because it's *Catra,* and I really, really like her, and I want everything to go just right and I can't just *leave that up to chance* because what if I'm wrong and it all goes to hell? I can't handle that. I couldn't–"

“Hey, distraction!” Bow said brightly, grabbing Adora’s arm. “Kissing. What do you think about kissing?”

“That’s a *terrible* distraction, Bow!” Glimmer hissed.

But Adora considered it. “I don’t know. I’ve never kissed anyone before. Except–” Adora swallowed hard, and ignored the way her friends’ eyes went wide. Her stomach swooped, the same way it always did when she thought about Hordak. “And that was only once, and I kicked him in the nuts afterwards, so I don’t think it counts.”

“It doesn’t,” Glimmer said firmly.

“Yeah, yeah, I know. I know.” Adora took a deep breath. “Wait. When is the dance?”

“Um,” Glimmer exchanged a glance with Bow, who shrugged. “Like… two days?”

“Two *days?* I’m never going to be ready in two days!” Adora groaned and flopped into a chair. “This is a disaster. Is it too late to disappear into the woods and carve out a life for myself eating squirrels and berries?”

“Yes. You would get yourself killed in four hours,” Glimmer said flatly.

“And we’d miss you!” Bow added. He paused. “I mean, if you went to live in the woods, not if you died. Not that we wouldn’t miss you if you died! Of course we would! We would totally miss you if you were dead! But we don’t want you to be dead, is the point.” He mumbled the last bit into his shirt, looking sheepish. Glimmer buried her head in her hands.

“I need more string,” Adora informed her friends, half-rising. She looked at her corkboard, across the room, where she had mapped out herself, Catra, and their respective friend groups, along with a list of every possibility Adora could think of that might happen

during the dance, with a contingency plan for each. "And maybe another corkboard."

"No! No more corkboards!" Glimmer glared at Adora. "You're going to be fine! You're amazing, Adora, and if Catra can't see that, then that's *her* loss!"

"Exactly," Bow said, taking charge. "Look. Adora. Look at me."

Adora did. Bow put his hands on her shoulders.

"It's going to be okay," he said. "Take a deep breath. You're going to be okay. You have made plans. You know what you're doing. And we will be there to back you up if anything goes wrong."

"With our fists if necessary!" Glimmer added. "Trust me, if Catra tries anything even *remotely* sketchy, I'm going to punch her so hard, her eyeballs will go down her throat, which will be super bloody 'cause I'll be strangling her, and her nose–"

"OKAY THAT'S ENOUGH IMAGERY THANK YOU GLIMMER," Bow said.

Adora laughed, and they both smiled at her. "I hope I won't need that… but thanks, guys." She stretched out and grinned at them, feeling the ever-present worry bubble back down to a manageable simmer.

"Maybe we can check out outfits now?" Glimmer suggested, and even Bow looked hopeful.

Sure," Adora said, bouncing out of the chair. "Show me what you got."

"When are we picking Adora up?"

"Like, six, I guess? I don't know, what time is it?" Catra dragged her fingers through her hair, wincing when her nails got caught on a snag. "Ugh. Scorpia, *help me."*

Scorpia rushed into the bathroom. "I told you you needed to get it cut! Short hair's more noticeable when it grows out weird."

"I forgot, okay?" Catra tugged her fingers out of her hair. *"Help me."*

Scorpia chuckled, and started working at it with a comb and some kind of spritz bottle. "You forgot to tie your bowtie."

Catra fingered the silk around her neck. "No, this is intentional. It looks better this way."

"If you say so." Scorpia gave one final tug at Catra's hair. "There. You're good, Wildcat."

"Ugh, thanks." Catra poked her head out of the bathroom and scanned Scorpia's bedroom. "Where'd Entrapta go?"

"Oh, she said something about 'get away from me with your evil brushes and your wicked, wicked mascara, you villain, traitor, and fiend,' so I think maybe she's hiding."

"Great," Catra sighed. "She *is* coming, right?"

"Oh, for sure. There'll be taquitos! And you *know* she loves tiny food."

"I'm not sure if taquitos are that small."

Scorpia looked alarmed. "But there's *-ito* right in the name! That's small! A small taco! Right?"

"Have you ever even *seen* a taquito? They're definitely, like, regular-sized foods."

"Oh noooo. I totally promised Entrapta that there'd be tiny foods."

Scorpia looked so crushed that Catra couldn't help but sigh. "Look, we'll stop by the grocery store on our way to pick up Adora and Perfuma, okay? I'll run in and grab some mini tarts. We'll be fine."

Scorpia sighed. “Yeah, okay.” She checked her watch and yelped. “Oh no! We have to get going if we want to get those.” She grinned up at Catra. “Ready, Wildcat?”

Catra looked at herself in the mirror and sighed. “As I’ll ever be. Let’s go.”

She grabbed her jacket off the chair and raced Scorpia out the door.

It took surprisingly little time to get the tarts, and even less time to pick up Catra’s and Scorpia’s respective dates, even though Catra had been exiled to the back seat so that Perfuma could ride shotgun while Scorpia drove.

“This is an outrage,” Catra said as she buckled in. “I feel oppressed.” She caught sight of Scorpia’s expression in the rearview mirror and quickly blurted out a “Kidding!”

From the passenger side, Perfuma glared at Catra, but luckily, the rest of the ride passed without incident and they soon arrived at school.

“I can’t believe we’re having prom in the *gym,”* Catra said, scrambling out of the car. “Aren’t you supposed to go to, like… a nice venue?”

“The gym has its own charm!” Scorpia said, getting out as well. “Like… the tall ceilings!”

“And what, the smell of feet?” Catra scoffed, and glanced back at the car.

Immediately, her location-related woes all flew out of her head.

Adora was wearing a high neck red dress and sandals, hair tied back in a ponytail. She looked at Catra worriedly, and Catra realized belatedly that she had been staring.

“You look nice,” Catra blurted out.

Adora looked startled, but she smiled. “Thanks. So do you.”

Catra tugged at her lapels. “Psh, this old thing?” She nodded at the gym doors, offering her elbow to Adora. “You ready?”

Absolutely not, Adora’s expression said, but she took a deep breath and seemed to steady herself. She smiled at Catra (and Catra totally ignored that stupid fluttering in her heart, it *wasn’t being helpful)* and took her elbow gracefully. “Let’s go.”

They walked into the gym.

Inside, there was a buffet (Catra put the plastic tart container towards the end and labeled it ENTRAPTA with a stray Sharpie) and decorations lining the walls, and when they sat down, for a brief moment, Catra was struck with the terror of *I don’t know what to say to this girl.*

They’d talked before. Of course they had. They’d gone places before, and it was always… comfortable, talking to Adora. Easy. Nice. It was even fun (when they weren’t being chased by Entrapta’s stupidly dangerous robots, that was).

So *how was it* that now, now, of all times, Catra found herself tongue-tied?

It was because of the prom, Catra knew it was. It was because– well– it was because they’d never done anything like this before. They’d hung out, sure, and they’d gone places together, but this was… this was something else entirely. This was something foreign, something brand-new.

This was a *date.*

Or, if it wasn’t a date, it was date-adjacent. After all, Catra had asked Adora and Adora alone, and they weren’t going as “just friends,” that’s for damn sure, and– and it was *prom.* Prom was a date thing. It just was.

So, yeah, Catra felt nervous.

She and Adora clapped politely as some girl in their class that Catra had literally never spoken to was crowned Prom Queen, and clapped politely again when some guy was named Prom King.

"I know that guy," Adora said suddenly. "He's on the football team."

Catra looked at her. "Oh, really?"

"Sure. His name's Swift Wind."

"That's an incredibly stupid name," Catra said without thinking, before realizing too late that Adora probably wouldn't appreciate that comment about her friend. "I mean… cool?"

But Adora was smiling a little. "No, you're right. He chose it himself, but... *boys,* you know?"

"Right." Catra looked back at the stage, where Swift Wind was giving a ridiculous bow.

"I don't get the hype about this," Adora said, and bit into a piece of bread.

"What? Prom King and Queen?"

"Yeah, I'm not really a Prom Queen kind of person," Adora said through her mouthful of bread.

Catra huffed out a laugh. "How 'bout a Prom Princess?"

"That's not a thing," Adora said dismissively, but then her eyes narrowed in suspicion. "Is it?"

"Shit, I don't know, princess." Catra reclined in her chair, feeling her nerves begin to die down as they talked. "I've never been to prom before."

Adora laughed, high-pitched and nervous, and it was probably the best thing Catra had ever heard. Had she ever heard Adora laugh

before? “Yeah, me neither.”

Across the room, the current song faded out, and a slower one came on.

Immediately, couples began pairing up. Sea Hawk and Mermista. Frosta and some guy Catra had never seen before. Lonnie and Kyle and Rogelio in a circle.

Scorpia, across the gym, was slow-dancing with Perfuma, looking quietly blissful. Bow and Glimmer were twirling each other around on the dance floor– and Catra noticed with no small amount of amusement that Glimmer was leading.

Catra looked across at Adora, who was fiddling with her napkin.

Well, it looked like she was going to have to make the first move.

Catra held out a hand. “Want to dance, princess?”

For a moment, Adora just looked at her. Then a smile spread, slow and beautiful.

“I’d love to,” she said, and took Catra’s hand.

Adora could feel her heart pounding at a bajillion miles an hour, and she desperately hoped Catra couldn’t see it.

After all, Catra was… cool. Confident. She probably didn’t get nervous over stupid things like what Adora got nervous over.

Like, for example, *where the hell you were supposed to put your hands while dancing.*

Which Adora had *no idea* how to do.

This was bad. This was so bad. She should have asked Glimmer or Bow for pointers about dancing. She should have written this out

on her corkboard. *Why hadn't she written this out on her corkboard?*

"Hey," Catra said, and Adora refocused to see her staring at Adora worriedly. "Are you okay?"

"Um. I. I don't know how to dance?" Adora said, voice squeaking upwards towards the end of her sentence as if she were asking a question.

But instead of looking surprised or annoyed, Catra just shrugged. "Neither do I, but if Scorpia and Perfuma and Bow and Glitter–"

"You mean *Glimmer."*

"–and even flipping *Kyle* can do it, then so can we." Catra pulled Adora closer, ignoring Adora's yelp.

Oh, god, she's so close. She's so close she's so close she's so close WHAT DO I DO?

Catra smirked at her, and Adora was pretty sure she would have just stopped functioning altogether and died right then and there on the dance floor if Catra's arms hadn't been there, holding her steady. "Just follow my lead, princess."

"Okay," Adora breathed, and Catra started swaying gently to the music.

"Come on, just like that. We don't need to be pro dancers or anything, just… move with me."

"Got it," Adora managed, and Catra smiled at her.

"See, we got this." There was a clatter on the other side of the gym, and Catra rolled her eyes at Adora. "Ten bucks that's Kyle's fault."

As if on cue, Adora heard Kyle yelping apologies over Lonnie's and Rogelio's grumbles. Despite herself, Adora smiled. Poor Kyle.

As the song wound down and began to segue into the next one, Adora finally started to get the hang of dancing– or swaying, more like. She hadn't stepped on Catra's toes yet, after all.

And then Catra gently swung Adora around, leaned down in a dip, and then Adora was clinging to her arms, staring up at her. Catra was smirking down at her, closer than ever, now, and suddenly, Adora knew *exactly* what she wanted to do.

Slowly, telegraphing her movements, Adora began to lean in– or lean *up,* she supposed. Her heart was pounding so hard she could hear it in her ears, but she didn't stop.

Catra drew closer.

Closer.

Closer…

And then Catra was leaning down too, and closing her eyes, and–

BEEP! BEEP! BEEP! BEEP!

Adora jerked away, shocked. Catra did the same.

"What the f–" Catra began, but the rest of her sentence was drowned out by the screeching of–

"The *fire alarm,"* Adora realized, a jolt of annoyance and anger going through her. "Are you *kidding* me?"

Beside her, Catra started to laugh, a high-pitched, ongoing cackle, and Adora suddenly didn't care quite so much about the alarm.

"Come on," she said, wrapping her arm around Catra's shoulders as the sprinklers started to hiss in warning. "Let's get out of here."

Catra stood outside, shivering and mentally cursing herself for not bringing a proper jacket, and wondering just how the heck she

was going to get home, especially now that Scorpia and Perfuma looked so enraptured with each other. Scorpia would give Catra a ride home if she asked, but Catra wasn't one to get in the way of her best friend's budding romance… not in the least because *yuck.*

She wished her stupid bike hadn't been wrecked. Not that she would really *want* to bike home in a suit, but still…

BEEP! BEEP! BEEP! BEE–

Abruptly, the alarm cut off, leaving the disgruntled students gathered silently in the parking lot.

Slowly, Catra looked around, at the suits and sparkling dresses and hair and makeup, everyone just looking at the building.

"Welp, I'm out," a voice said, and there was a general mumbling of agreement among the crowd as slowly, they began to disperse, heading off to cars and bus stops and sidewalks.

Prom night was over.

Catra tried not to feel too disappointed about it, but she felt a pang in her chest all the same.

"Great timing," a voice said in her ear, and Catra turned to see Adora standing there, grinning awkwardly. "Seriously, of all the times for a fire drill…"

"Right?" Catra said. "I mean, who set it off in the first place?"

"IT WAS HIM!" a new voice said, and Catra turned to see Mermista, another student in their class, dragging her boyfriend towards her car. "Who brings *matches* to a *school event,* Sea Hawk? *MATCHES!"*

"I wanted to illustrate my burning desire for you!" Catra heard him answer, and Mermista groaned, tugged him into the car, and started the engine.

Catra turned back to Adora, eyebrows lifted.

“Yeah, that wasn’t ideal,” she said.

“Kinda ruined the mood,” Adora agreed.

“Ah, well,” Catra said, and mustered a smile. “The perfect prom kiss isn’t really my thing, anyways.”

Adora smiled back.

And then Catra grabbed her shoulders, tugged her down in one smooth movement, and pressed her lips to Adora’s in one perfect, shining, everlasting moment that stretched on and on and into forever.

End Notes

Tell me what you thought?

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!